popularly known as OBCs). And diametrically opposite to this, OBC groups demanded the expansion of the OBC quota (after a caste census), but did not want any carving out of existing entitlements meant for them. It was difficult to reconcile these three contrasting demands, but this is *the* foremost question before India today (especially given this is the first generation, which, though better educated than the previous, cannot hope for a better lifestyle as easily as before). Given this, it would have been worthwhile to initiate a conversation between these groups (if only as a test case). However, when the actual meeting happened (albeit with only two of the aforementioned groups; the third had to be slotted as a walking interaction because of paucity of time and space), efforts were made to dismiss the questions. There also seemed no meeting ground, and there was palpable distrust in the air.

Finally, Rahul Gandhi proactively intervened to answer the questions sensitively and intelligently. He also tried to form bridges between different perspectives, suggesting that they all had similar needs and aspirations. Disarmingly, Rahul Gandhi also went on to concede that he himself had to struggle to check regressive impulses within the party organization and invited those present in the room to join the party to ensure it became a vehicle to drive their agenda. Unsurprisingly, every single person in that room was a convert by the end of the meeting.

In interaction after interaction (as Bhanwar Meghwanshi and Darshan Mondkar attest to in their articles), everything Rahul Gandhi did served as a foil to Prime Minister Narendra Modi's carefully scripted and manicured persona. Unlike PM Modi's foreboding formality and stiffness, Rahul Gandhi came across as compassionate, relatable and warm. He hugged people, irrespective of who they were or where they came from (thus transcending caste, class, creed and any orthodox walls we draw for ourselves). He wasn't patronizing or closed-hearted. Two historical figures similarly consciously juxtaposed themselves to an aloof and formal system —Mahatma Gandhi and Princess Diana. Becoming brands in themselves, they radically disrupted the status quo through their body of work and their meaningful expressions of care. They consciously alleviated the